Operations on the western front

In the west, XV Corps' five infantry divisions (3, 10, 19, 25 and 26) and two independent brigades (3 Armoured and 121 Infantry) were deployed in Jammu & Kashmir. On 3 December, Pakistan's 23 Infantry Division launched an offensive towards Chhamb, capturing the Mandiala Heights on 4 December. A counter-attack mounted by India's 10 Infantry Division was unsuccessful. During the night of 4/5 December, Pakistani forces captured Chhamb, while Indian troops captured the 'chicken-neck' area. After this, the Pakistan Army made no further attempts to cross the Munawar Tawi River and the situation stabilized, with local counterattacks continuing until 17 December.

In the Poonch sector, Pakistani forces captured some areas in the 93 Infantry Brigade sector but the Indians recovered the lost positions. In the Kargil sector, India's 121 (Independent) Infantry Brigade captured some important outposts after fierce fighting amid adverse weather conditions.



Indian troops repair the Jessore road, covered by a soldier with a 7.62mm 1A LMG, a modernized version of the Bren identifiable by its less-curved magazine. (William Lovelace/Daily Express/Getty Images)